JUNIOR CHURCH APP ENHANCEMENT PROPOSAL

Safeguarding, Attendance Management and Parent Engagement Enhancements

Prepared for: Junior Church Leadership Team

Date: June 2026

Executive Summary

The Junior Church is currently developing a digital application to support the check-in and check-out of children attending services. This proposal recommends a number of safeguarding and operational enhancements that may be incorporated into the application design. The objective is to ensure that the platform not only manages attendance but also supports safeguarding compliance, parent communication, incident reporting, accountability, and leadership oversight.

Background

As safeguarding processes become increasingly embedded within Junior Church operations, technology can be used to improve consistency, documentation, communication, and accountability. Incorporating these requirements during the design stage may be more efficient and cost-effective than introducing them after the application has been deployed.

Proposed Functional Enhancements

1. Parent Safeguarding Information Portal

Access to safeguarding policy, parent code of conduct, child behaviour expectations, drop-off and pick-up procedures, photography guidelines, emergency procedures and reporting contacts. Parents acknowledge understanding electronically.

2. Safeguarding Concerns and Feedback Portal

Parents can submit safeguarding concerns, complaints and feedback. Each submission receives a unique reference and status tracking.

3. Emergency Notification Centre

Push notifications, SMS and email communication for closures, emergencies, security concerns and health alerts.

4. Teacher Incident Reporting Module

Teachers record behavioural incidents, injuries, bullying, medical issues and safeguarding concerns. The system captures date, time, location, children involved, actions taken and parent communication.

5. Incident Tracking and Case Management

Automated incident numbering, action tracking, communication logs, document storage and safeguarding audit trails.

6. Approved Pick-Up Verification

Recording authorised collectors, emergency contacts and alerts for unauthorised collection attempts.

7. Leadership Dashboard

Attendance trends, safeguarding statistics, open cases, closed cases and parent feedback reporting.

Suggested Safeguarding Workflow

Parent Concern Submitted → Safeguarding Team Review → Assessment → Parent Communication → Resolution / Escalation → Closure Teacher Incident Report → Safeguarding Team Review → Risk Assessment → Parent Notification → Follow-Up Actions → Case Closure High-Risk Safeguarding Matter → Immediate Escalation → Safeguarding Lead → Leadership Review → Investigation → Resolution

Priority Classification

Must Have: • Child Registration • Check-In / Check-Out • Parent Registration • Approved Pick-Up Verification • Parent Safeguarding Information Page Should Have: • Emergency Notifications • Teacher Incident Reporting • Parent Feedback Portal • Incident Tracking Nice to Have: • Leadership Dashboard • Safeguarding Analytics • Volunteer Compliance Monitoring

Recommended Implementation Phases

Phase 1 • Registration • Attendance Management • Parent Portal • Pick-Up Verification • Emergency Notifications Phase 2 • Incident Reporting • Parent Feedback and Concerns • Safeguarding Case Management Phase 3 • Leadership Dashboard • Reporting and Analytics • Volunteer Compliance Monitoring

Conclusion and Discussion Points

The recommendations contained in this document are intended to support the existing app development initiative by ensuring that future safeguarding and operational requirements are considered from the outset. The Leadership Team is invited to review these recommendations and provide comments on: 1. Additional requirements. 2. Priority features. 3. Development feasibility. 4. Suggested amendments. 5. Implementation sequencing. Following leadership review, a final requirements document may be prepared for discussion with the development team.